

1891

**TRANS-SIBERIAN RAILWAY BEGUN**

Brainchild of Tsar Alexander III, the railway was designed to run 9,198 km (5,715 miles) from Moscow to the eastern port of Vladivostok. Construction started eastward from Moscow and westward from Vladivostok. Tens of thousands worked on the railroad, including skilled workers, peasants, and prisoners. Trains had to be ferried over Lake Baikal but by 1904 all sections were completed, opening up Siberia.

▽ Engineers on the Trans-Siberian railway



1892

**ELLIS ISLAND OPENS**

With an ever-increasing number of immigrants from Central, Eastern, and Southern Europe making their way to the US, a federal immigration station was opened on Ellis Island in New York Harbour, close to the Statue of Liberty. Seven hundred immigrants passed through on the first day, followed by nearly 450,000 over the course of the year. They included Jews fleeing pogroms in Russia and Italians escaping poverty. In 1900-1914, some 1,900 immigrants arrived daily.

▷ Immigrants arriving in New York



1890

**1891 Eugene Dubois**, a Dutch paleoanthropologist, finds bone fragments in Java; he names them *Pithecanthropus erectus*, later known as "Java Man"



1890

**MASSACRE AT WOUNDED KNEE**

Devastated by the loss of their lands and livelihoods, Sioux people adopted a ritual Ghost Dance, believing their lands and culture would be restored. The US government saw this as a provocation and sent forces to Wounded Knee Creek, Dakota, to disarm the Lakota Sioux. Between 150 and 300 Sioux were killed.

◁ Chief They-Fear-His-Horse, negotiator after Wounded Knee

“Soldiers cut down my timber... kill my buffalo... my heart feels like bursting.”

SANTANA, KIOWA CHIEF, 1867, FROM BURY MY HEART AT WOUNDED KNEE, DEE BROWN